

25SMCV00859 25SMCV00859

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

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TENTATIVE RULING

July 28, 2026

25SMCV00859 (Armstrong v. Yoo, et.
al.)

RELEVANT BACKGROUND

On February 18, 2025,
plaintiff Christopher Armstrong (Plaintiff) filed his complaint. On July 7,
2025, Plaintiff filed his first amended complaint (FAC) against Tomas Soongmin
Yoo (Yoo), Jenny Jechart (Jechart), and Does 1-25, alleging eleven causes of action.
Plaintiff alleges that Yoo acted as a financial advisor to Plaintiff and that
Yoo's aunt, Jechart, is also a financial advisor who manages Yoo's trust and
other assets and colluded with Yoo. (FAC ¶ 8-10.)

INSTANT MOTION

On June 15, 2026, Plaintiff filed
the instant motions to compel Jechart's further responses to Special
Interrogatories, Set One (Nos. 5, 6, 7, 41, 43, 53, and 66) and Requests for
Production, Set One (Nos. 7, 12, 18, and 28).

MEET AND CONFER

The Court finds that Plaintiff has
satisfied the meet and confer requirement. (See Cantor Decl. ¶ 5, 7, 9, 15.)

DISCUSSION

Here,

Plaintiff seeks further responses to the identified discovery served on December 30, 2025 [Special Interrogatories] and November 18, 2025 [Requests for Production] on the basis that, despite three rounds of supplemental responses, Jechart's responses remain deficient and not code-compliant. (Cantor Decl. ¶ 2-10.)

In

opposition, Jechart argues that Plaintiff's motion should be denied because the responses are sufficient, but Jackart does not address each discovery request individually. Jackart also contends that Plaintiff's motion is built on inconsistent meet-and-confer correspondence that does not accurately track the actual discovery served. But the Court is not persuaded and finds that the Cantor declaration satisfies the meet-and-confer requirement.

Special Interrogatories

The

Court notes that Plaintiff's separate statement does not fully comply with the requirements of California Rules of Court, rule 3.1345, which requires Plaintiff to set forth "(1) The text of the request, interrogatory, question, or inspection demand; [and] (2) The text of each response, answer, or objection, and any further responses or answers..." (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 3.13.345, subd. (c)(1)-(2).) Plaintiff's separate statement at times summarizes the requests and responses rather than providing the actual text. (See Plaintiff's Separate Statement.)

Additionally,

the Court notes that Plaintiff has failed to provide the Court with Jechart's initial responses to Special Interrogatories, Set One. The Cantor Declaration provides the supplemental responses, but not the initial responses. (See Cantor Decl. Exhibits.) Also, since Plaintiff failed to provide the exact requests and responses verbatim in the separate statement, the Court cannot adequately determine whether the responses are deficient. The meet-and-confer letters also appear to indicate that the initial responses included objections, but, again, the initial responses have not been provided to the Court.

Accordingly,
Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to Special Interrogatories, Set One, is DENIED on procedural grounds. Plaintiff's request for monetary sanctions is DENIED.

Requests for Production

The Court notes that the
separate statement provided by Plaintiff appears to concern a different case.
Accordingly, Plaintiff failed to provide a
separate statement as required by California Rules of Court, rule 3.1345.

Accordingly,
Plaintiff's motion to compel further responses to requests for production set one is DENIED on procedural grounds. Plaintiff's request for monetary sanctions is DENIED.